STUDENTS' TECHNICAL COUNCIL

fampay

14-16 APRIL 2023

TECHSHILA

INTER BHAWAN TECH MEET

Product Management

#7

FamPay's Product Challenge

College is a unique time in a person's life where they have the opportunity to grow and develop in a variety of ways. By prioritising these four elements - a supportive community, intellectual growth, social development, and professional development - students can create a college experience that is both fulfilling and rewarding.

'A good college is a continuously evolving entity that adapts and thrives in given conditions. And the responsibility is on every student of that college to make it happen.' - *Barack Obama*

As you go about your college journey, have you ever ranted about specific aspects of your college that you think should be changed?? Ofc, as a normal IITR nibba you must have!

An eventful college life!

A good college life is like a symphony,
With each note played in perfect harmony.
Academic pursuits, a symphonic score,
Hands-on challenges faced, and lessons learned galore.

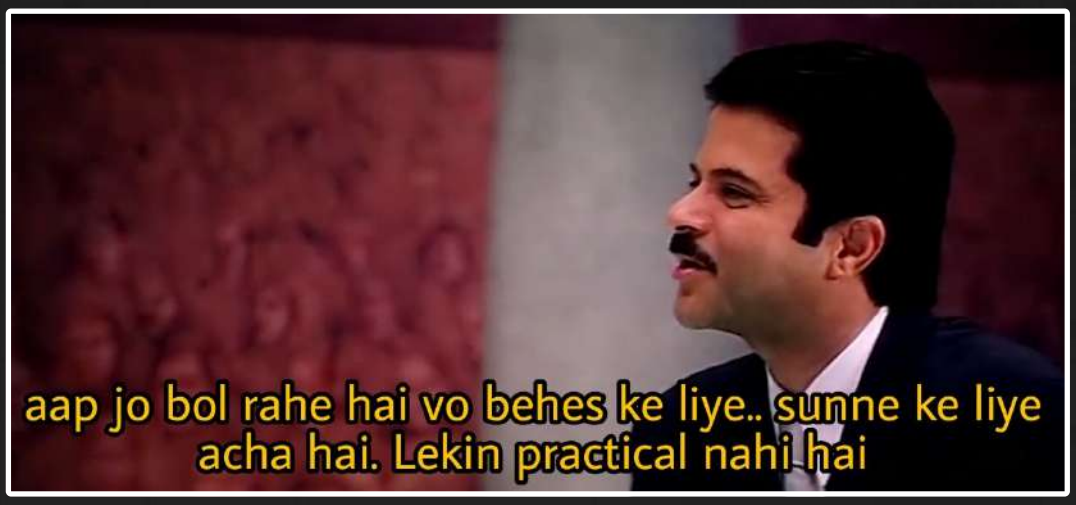
Personal growth, a solo melody,
Exploring passions, building identity.
Social connections, a rich chord progression,
Friendships formed, a sense of belonging and connection.

Diverse community, a rainbow of sound,
Different cultures, perspectives profound.
A college dating life, a romance to unfold,
A tapestry of emotions, stories to be told.

So let the music play, let it roar,
Embrace these challenges, and open the door.
With technologies improving, let the mind soar,
Suggest us some great ideas, to enhance it more!

Problem Statement

Let me ask - What would you do if someone gave you a chance to become director of IIT Roorkee for a day?? Haha, think deeply!



Changing things requires leadership, innovation, and a willingness to take action.
We, as technological leaders, can play a crucial role in shaping our society and driving positive change in the organisation.

The problem statement is divided into 3 parts

1. Category A
2. Category B
3. Bounty PS

While the theme of Category A is about the professional and learning-related aspects. The theme of Category B is regarding the emotional, cultural and other possible aspects of college life that can be improved. Some of the problem statements are described below, but the teams are free to choose a different or even combination of problem statements. The problem statement, the reason to solve it, its feasibility and the impact of solving it should make sense at the end of the day!

Category A

Campus Groups:
Learning groups are an essential aspect of college life. These groups provide students with the opportunity to collaborate, share ideas, and gain knowledge from one another. In addition, they allow students to develop essential skills such as communication, leadership, and problem-solving.Group working and organisational structure have been pretty same for many years. IIT Roorkee has been known to have one of the best technical development cultures in the country. From collaborating with fellow groups, creating required working verticals for groups (eg: marketing team), better accountability of performance & budgets, open workshops, and participation in well-known competitions, taking government projects. The upside potential for the space is immense!!

Internship Opportunities:
Not getting an internship is among the most common nightmares college students encounter. Getting more internships for your college is solving a marketplace problem. It has two sides demand (aka companies) and supply (aka college students). Using already existing systems like - PIC, tech groups, cult groups, IITRAA etc, may be helpful/necessary for an initial kickstart.

https://www.lennysnewsletter.com/p/how-to-kickstart-and-scale-a-marketplace - read only phase 1 for reference

External Projects:
They are an excellent way to improve college students' learning experience. They offer numerous benefits - Earn Money. Build portfolio. Gain practical knowledge. Develop critical soft skills such as communication, collaboration, and leadership. Network with professionals in the field.

Getting more external projects is similar to solving the internship problem except for the fact that the results of the projects are quantitatively measurable. As a problem solver, your job is to make systems in place such that not only the opportunities increase, but the quality of the projects delivered also remains good, keeping in mind long-term goals and relationships with the clients!

Skills Improvement:
IQ is not what the smartest 1% of India struggles with; We struggle with 'Discipline'. What looks like discipline is often a carefully created environment to encourage certain behaviours. The people with the best defaults are typically the ones with the best environment. Sometimes it's carefully chosen, and sometimes it's just plain luck. Either way, it's easier to align yourself with the proper behaviour in the right environment.

Make sound systems to offer opportunities and support to students of IIT Roorkee for skill development. Most skill development programs end up being a short burst of enthusiasm.Good system design is key to the sustainability of the project.

Category B

Humans are social animals. Human relationships also have a compounding effect, and this is where most of the gains are! We as a community thrive by improving in these 4 aspects - competing, supporting, learning and sharing/ interacting with one another. But improving in these aspects require breaking away from a social barrier
Frankly, many students lack the ability to make and sustain deeper connections. Find out what makes for healthy peer/ romantic/ professional/political/ cultural relationships. Think of ways in which you could trigger people to connect with one another, form social bonds and sustain healthy relationships.

Peer Learning:
One of the main reasons people join IIT is to have the best peer group possible. People discussing hard and essential problems, and having those geeky talks is what comes to mind after hearing IIT! But pondering now, peer learning could be more exponential than the present situation.

Alum / Seniors:
They have access to knowledge and funds to support the community's growth. Find their incentives to help college students and build your solution around it.

Food, Transportation & Necessary Goods:
While food, transportation and goods may seem like minor details in the grand scheme of college life, they can have a big impact on a student's experience. By taking advantage of dining options, planning for transportation and available business opportunities, students can get away from unnecessary loads to make the most of their college years. The MVP need not be the best technical solution, but the business and behavioural aspects are the primary concerns.

Others:
Any other aspect of college life that can be improved (eg: dating, mentorship, trips, etc) is free to be taken as a problem statement for Category B only.

Bounty PS

Solving this Problem Statement is optional. The page limit for this PS is 1.5 pages (Text size 11)

Technical Hiring Solutions:
It has always been difficult for students to showcase their potential/ talent/ skill level quantitatively. (like the rating of players in FIFA esports). Just imagine how fun would a gamified experience, with global rankings, where companies bid for the best potential candidate. This could potentially spare students lots of time!
A novel technical solution which solves the problem with a new perspective, which may not be perfect, is all we want.
Concentrate on a particular niche before expanding your ideas to other domains.

PS: Just describe the solution, its working and the principles behind it.

TASK:
Take 2 problem statements, one from category A and one from category B. And do the following task for each problem statement.

1. State the problem statement you are trying to solve.
2. User Research Look at the current state of the chosen problem with help of extensive research and feedback from students, faculty, and staff.

- Statedown different stakeholders involved

- Write down the pain points and job-to-be-done of required stakeholders.

https://jobs-to-be-done.com/jobs-to-be-done-a-framework-for-customer-needs-c883cbf61c90

- Point-wise, describe the required behavioural/ business/ product insights you have learned.

3. Present a value proposition canvas of the chosen solution (https://www.strategyzer.com/canvas/value-proposition-canvas)

4. Describe your solution and actions that will be taken to achieve the desired outcome, such as implementing new technologies, revising the curriculum, and providing additional support services.

5. State any potential challenges or obstacles and outline a plan for addressing them. PS: Change of organisational structure and working || Rules and regulations change to be underlined separately in this task.

6. Describe the success metrics and methods for measuring progress and evaluating the effectiveness of the improvement efforts.

Evaluation Metrics

User Research: 25
Aligning value propositions for long-term sustainability: 25
Impact: 25
Feasibility of implementation: 15
Bounty PS:10

Participation

The maximum team size is 6 members.

Submission

1. Do not submit a design prototype or wireframing unless required to describe your solution.
2. Do not over-expand the solution. Keep the doc crisp and interesting to read!
3. Submission limit for PS of category A and category B is a maximum of 2.5 pages each with text size 11.
   Max limit = (2.5 + 2.5 + 1.5) = 6.5 pages

Deadline : 14th April , 11:59 PM

Note

1. The submissions are going to be verified as a project.
2. Suggestions from the relevant submissions may be implemented. We will set up a meeting with you to follow up on the suggestions.